GER in higher education must be targeted to increase from nearly 18 per cent at present to say 25 per cent by 2016-17.

Elementary and Secondary Education 13.30The government has initiated many schemes for elementary and secondary education. Some are as follows:

Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA)/Right to Education (RTE)

Free education for all children between the ages of 6 and 14 years has been made a fundamental right under the RTE Act 2009. While the RTE Act was notified on 27 August 2009 for general information, the notification for enforcing the provisions of the Act with effect from April 1, 2010 was issued on February 16, 2010. It mandates that every child has a right to elementary education of satisfactory and equitable quality in a formal school which satisfies certain essential norms and standards. The reform processes initiated in 2010-11 continued during the year 2011-12. Some recent developments in this regard include:

(i) Notification of Central RTE Rules on 8 April 2010, followed by notification of State RTE Rules by the states,

(ii) Revision of the SSA norms to correspond with the provisions of the RTE Act including norms for sanctioning additional teacher posts, classrooms, teaching-learning equipment to enable states to move to an eight-year elementary education cycle, enhancement of academic support for better school supervision, and expansion of Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas (KGBVs),

(iii) Revision of the fund- sharing pattern between the central and state governments for implementation of RTE-SSA programme from the earlier pattern in the sliding scale to a 65:35 ratio between the centre and states for a five-year period from 2010-11 to 2014-15,

(iv) Notification of the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE) as the academic authority for laying down teacher qualifications,

(v) Launching of a country-wide campaign for raising public awareness about the RTE and mobilising communities to ensure that all schools become RTE compliant.

National Programme for Education of Girls at Elementary Level (NPEGEL)